

Nanotech Teabag

New technology for filtering contaminants and bacteria out of water using a nanotech teabag-like design created

47-inch vending machine

The Japanese government has installed a 47-inch vending machine in Tokyo to display and choose products.

Bazaar

Gigabyte GA-X58A-UD3R

The one for us mortals!

The Core i7 processor is the undisputed processor in the market today, but its popularity hasn't been as strong as Intel would have hoped. Some of the causes have been the high costs of DDR3 memory and also of the expensive motherboards based on the sole chipset for the platform - Intel's X58.

The Gigabyte GA-X58A-UD3R is an ATX motherboard with plenty of features but offered at a somewhat acceptable price. For the most part, it's like the previous X58 models from Gigabyte such as the GA-X58A-UD7

The layout of the board



is somewhat cramped. The heatsinks connected by the heatpipes block the first of the PCIe x1 slots. The memory slots are also somewhat closer to the processor. We managed to fit in a humongous Cooler Master V6 GT CPU cooler on the board without any problems. However, the first of the DIMM slots were

covered by it. The first two PCI Express x16 slots are also very closely stacked, so setting up a SLI or CrossFire setup might be difficult.

One of the key features however is the included USB 3.0 functionality. Another nifty feature is Gigabyte Cloud OC. We would have liked to see dedicated Power on and Reset buttons on the board itself. PC Mark gave an overall score of 12,828 while Cinebench gave a score of 15701 for CPU. Video encoding took 22 seconds for a 100MB file. Crysis gave a frame rate of 59 fps at 1280x1024, High setting.

Priced at ₹12,900, it's an affordable X58 board which is overclockable as well.

Specifications

Socket: LGA 1366, Chipset: Intel X58 Express, 6 x DDR3 DIMM sockets, 2 x PCIe x16 slots, 2 x PCIe x1 slots, 1 x PCI slot, USB 3.0 supported

Contact

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Web site: www.giga-byte.co.in

Price: Rs 12,990

7.0/10

Features.....	7.5
Performance.....	7.5
Build Quality.....	7.0
Value for money.....	7.0

LG Cookie Plus

Want another cookie?

Specifications

Screen Size: 3.0 inches (240x400px), 3.0MP Camera, 900mAh battery, Dimensions (L x W x H): 107 x 52.5 x 11.5 mm, Weight: 92.5 grams

Contact

LG Electronics India

Phone: 1800-180-9999

Web site: www.lg.com/in

Price: ₹9,500

6.0/10

Features.....	7.0
Performance.....	5.5
Build Quality.....	6.5
Value for money.....	6.0

The Cookie Plus aka GS500v is a sleek bit of work with a nice solid in-hand feeling. The phone isn't as slim as we'd like. The materials used on the body seem pretty upmarket, and while the 3.0-inch resistive touchscreen dominates the front.

One of the major deterrents on the hardware is the resistive touchscreen. The touchscreen is sluggish, and coupled with the phones' (sometimes) sluggish interface is a recipe for a socialising disaster. Facebook, Twitter and Myspace are all widgets accessible via one of the home screens. The interface is

a little gimmicky. Browsing is decent on account of the size of the display. However, the lower resolution of 240 x 400 pixels leaves something to be desired. The onscreen keypad suffers in terms of usability on account of the touchscreen as well.

The camera lacks autofocus and a flash. The image quality is average. Music playback quality is pretty decent, we found bass to be lacking. The loudspeaker clarity is mediocre. Our signal clarity testing showed clarity loss and a couple of dropped calls and voices were generally muffled and conversations kept getting interrupted.



There were no issues in zone one or zone two.

An MRP of ₹9,500 seems a little high, especially when the phone lacks a dedicated QWERTY. However, these two grouses aside the Cookie Plus is, for the most part a decent phone.